



Curricular Practical Training (CPT) Policy and Procedures

Curricular Practical Training (CPT) is a temporary off-campus work/internship authorization for current full-time F-1 students who want to gain practical experience in their field of study before the completion of their program. The internship position must be an integral part or a required part of the student's curriculum. This includes any type of required internship or practicum, or any required work in the student's major field of study for which course credit is received. F-1 students must obtain CPT authorization (CPT I-20) from the UCR ISS office prior to working off-campus.

CPT Eligibility

To be eligible for CPT, an F-1 student must:

- Have a valid F-1 immigration status at UCR and be enrolled as a full time student at UCR.
- Have completed one full academic year as a full-time student prior to CPT request in a valid F-1 student status. You may use time spent in valid F-1 status before starting at UCR to count towards this requirement if you have the same SEVIS number as your prior school. However, time spent studying English at a SEVIS approved school, does not count towards the one year requirement.
- You may use time spent in another qualified immigration status (e.g., E-2, H-4) if you changed your status to F-1 while in the U.S. as long as you were consecutively enrolled in a full time qualified program at a SEVP approved university or college for one academic year.
- Be making normative progress in their academic program and in good standing (please refer to your academic department policies)
- Have a job offer at the time of application
 - Have a job position that is integral to their established curriculum
 - Note: For PhD students who have advanced to candidacy, the job position must be integral to their dissertation research.
- Be concurrently enrolled in an internship course (i.e., 198i, 298i, or 398i).

Additional Information regarding Eligibility

- Graduate students in filing fee status are not eligible for CPT.
- 12 months of full-time CPT will cancel the student's OPT eligibility. Part-time CPT will not impact OPT eligibility.
- Per Graduate Division policy, graduate students may not be employed more than 50% (20 hrs. per week) including on-campus and off-campus employment combined.

How to Apply for CPT

1. Gather and complete the required CPT application documents:
 - a. CPT Request Form
 - b. Offer Letter on Letterhead (see sample letter)
 - i. The offer letter must include the following information: Company letterhead, Your Name, Job Title, Job Duties/Responsibilities, Company Address, Working Hours per Week, Start Date, End Date, Company Information, Salary, Employer's Signature
 - c. Enroll in the appropriate internship course (i.e., 198i, 298i, or 398i course)
2. Submit CPT documents to the UCR ISS Office (internationalstudents@ucr.edu):
 - a. Offer Letter on Letterhead
 - b. CPT Request Form
 - c. Proof of enrollment in internship course
3. An ISS Advisor will review CPT documents. *Please allow 10-12 business days for processing.*
4. An ISS Advisor will email the new I-20 with CPT authorization to the student's UCR email (R'mail).
5. Once the F-1 student receives the CPT I-20, they may begin working within the CPT authorization dates on the I-20.

CPT Authorization Policies

- F-1 students may not begin working off-campus until they receive the CPT authorization (CPT I-20) from the UCR ISS office. Working before receiving proper work authorization is a violation of F-1 status.
- It is the student's responsibility to consider the processing timeline and file in a timely manner.
- CPT authorization cannot be backdated.
- CPT is authorized for a specific employer. You cannot change jobs to another employer while on CPT. If you wish to engage in CPT with a different employer, an entirely new CPT application must be submitted.
- Students are required to complete their internship course to remain legally employed while on CPT.
- F-1 I-20 program extensions will not be granted for the purpose of CPT.
- CPT requests are only approved on a quarterly basis.
 - The earliest CPT start date is generally the start date of the quarter. However, you may choose a start date that begins during the break immediately before the internship quarter if you have an academic reason to do so.
 - The latest CPT end date is generally the last day of the quarter. However, you may choose an end date that ends during the quarter break immediately after the internship quarter and before the next day of instruction if:
 - you have an academic reason for extended dates
 - you will continue to be a student enrolled in the next quarter (filing fee excluded).
- Each quarter requires new CPT application forms.
- **Fall, Spring, Winter Quarters:** During the academic term, CPT is limited to part-time (20 hrs. or less per week). The only exception is for PhD students who have advanced to candidacy and require full-time CPT during the academic term in order to complete their thesis/dissertation research. These students must obtain approval and an explanation from their Graduate Advisor on the CPT Request Form. Undergraduate students participating in the UCDC program should see an advisor for information about that program specifically.
- **Summer:** During the summer break, continuing students may request full-time (more than 20 hrs. per week) or part-time (20 hrs. or less per week) working hours if they will be continuing students in the Fall quarter.
- Graduate students should consult with Graduate Division and their department to ensure that engaging in CPT does not impact any scholarship, fellowship, TA or GSR support.



International Students and Scholars

University of California, Riverside
900 University Ave, Student Services
Building, Second Floor, Riverside, CA
92521

Website: international.ucr.edu

Phone: 951-827-4113

Email: internationalstudents@ucr.edu

Dear Employer,

Students in F-1 status, who want to pursue Curricular Practical Training (CPT) or an internship program in their field of study, are required to obtain a job offer letter from their prospective employer before being authorized for the practical training.

Please provide a letter that includes the following information:

- Description of the training program, including its location, the name and address of the training supervisor, number of hours per week, salary, and dates of the training
- Goals and objectives of the training program
- Statement acknowledging that the training relates to the student's major field of study.

If the student does not already have a Social Security number, they will need to apply for one at the Social Security Administration office, and this job offer letter will need to be included in the application for SSN. If the student will be applying for a Social Security number, please also include the following information in the letter:

- Job title/position
- Supervisor's contact information (most importantly the phone number and email address)

Sample letter

(For Company/Institution Offering CPT Internship for an International Student In F-1 status),

This letter is to support the participation in an F-1 Curricular Practical Training work-based learning experience of F-1 student, **(Name of Student)**.

We agree to provide the student with an educational work-based learning experience (internship) directly related to the student's major field of study, fulfilling all or part of the student's degree or internship course enrollment requirement.

Please see below for the specific details of the student's internship position:

- Company Name
- Company Address
- Student's Job Title
- Job Duties and Responsibilities
- Goals and Objectives of the training program
- Number of hours per week
- Start Date and End Date
- Salary

- Supervisor's Name (Please Note: Supervisor must NOT be an F-1 or J-1 visa student)
- Supervisor's Job Title
- Supervisor's Contact Information (Phone or Email)

If you have any questions, I can be reached at (email and phone number).

Thank you.

Sincerely,

Employer's Signature (Digital or Handwritten Signature)

Employer's Name

Employer's Official Title



Curricular Practical Training (CPT) I-20 Request Form

Section A: Student Information (To be Completed by the Student)				
Family Name:		Given Name:		
UCR Student ID:	Email:	Phone:		
U.S. Address:	City:	State:	Zip Code:	
Degree Level: Bachelor ☐ Master ☐ Doctorate ☐		Major:		
Are you currently employed on-campus? Yes ☐ No ☐ If yes, how many hrs. per week? _____		Which term is your final quarter? Year: _____ Fall ☐ Spring ☐ Summer ☐ Winter ☐		

Section B: CPT Employment Information (To be Completed by the Student)	
CPT Quarter:	Year: _____ Fall ☐ Spring ☐ Summer ☐ Winter ☐
Company Name:	Position Title
Company Address:	Unit #:
City Name:	State: Zip Code:
CPT Start Date:	CPT End Date:
How many hours per week will you be working? Hours per Week: _____ ☐ Part-Time (20 hrs. or less per week) ☐ Full-Time (more than 20 hrs. per week)	
I have read and understand the requirements of CPT. I certify that this internship opportunity is an integral part of my established curriculum and understand my responsibilities in relation to my CPT authorization. I understand that I cannot begin my internship before receiving my I-20 with CPT authorization dates and that I cannot engage in CPT with an employer other than the one indicated on my CPT I-20. I understand that my CPT authorization will be revoked if I withdraw from my internship course. I certify that this internship is directly related to my major at UCR and that I have not completed my program requirements.	
Student's Signature	Date of Signature

Section C: Academic Department Review/Approval (To be Completed by the Advisor)

Undergraduate Students = Academic Advisor, Graduate Students = Graduate/ Faculty Advisor

Please select one to explain how this CPT experience is an integral part of the student's curriculum:

☐ **Degree Requirement:** I certify that this internship is a required part of the student's program. All students in the program are required to complete an internship in order to graduate as outlined in the course catalog. The internship is directly related to the students' major course of study.

☐ **Non-Required Course Credit:** I certify that this internship is a non-required part of the program that is integral to the student's program of study (i.e. will contribute to student's research efforts) pursuant to a credit-bearing course with a practical training component (please enter the course information below). The internship is directly related to the student's major course of study.

By signing this form, I certify that this student is academically eligible for an internship per our program/degree requirements and that it is integral to their major program of study, thus meeting Department of Homeland Security eligibility requirements for an off-campus internship.

Internship Course Title:	Quarter/Year:
Internship Goals:	How will the internship be evaluated? What academic deliverables are required for the internship?
Anticipated Program Completion Quarter/Year:	Has the student advanced to PhD candidacy? Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A ☐
If this is a PhD student who has Advanced to Candidacy, please explain how the CPT experience is integral to the student's completion of the thesis/dissertation. If the student is requesting full-time CPT during the academic term (Fall/Spring/Winter), please explain why a full-time internship is required.	
Advisor's Printed Name:	Department: Telephone number: Email address:
Advisor's Signature:	Date:

Office Use Only: Graduate Division Approval

Graduate Division Representative Signature: